

SERVES TWO BRUNCH SERVES TWO

Pumpkin French Toast Bake

with Cream Cheese Glaze

Perfect for lazy mornings or as a make-ahead brunch for special occasions, baked French toast is a simple way to get breakfast on the table. Today's seasonal version infuses pumpkin purée, milk, and eggs with pumpkin pie spices, vanilla extract, and brown sugar to form a custard bath for cubes of crusty bread. Instead of maple syrup, we're topping this baked, pudding-like French toast with a tangy cream cheese frosting.

40–50 minutes 2 servings 880 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1 boule loaf
- 3 ounces cream cheese
- 12 ounces milk
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 teaspoon pumpkin pie spice
- ¼ cup light brown sugar
- 6 eggs
- 1 can pumpkin purée
- 1 packet unsalted butter
- 2 tablespoons chopped pecans
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar
- 1 8" aluminum tin

You'll need

kosher salt
baking sheet
10" medium pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

You only need 3 eggs and ⅓ cup pumpkin purée for this recipe. Save remaining eggs and pumpkin for another recipe, like your favorite pumpkin bread.

Nuts can burn quickly, so keep an eye on them and stir frequently as they toast.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 350°F. Cut or tear **boule** into 2-inch cubes. Place **cream cheese** and **¼ cup milk** in a medium bowl (save remaining milk for the next step). Set aside to soften at room temperature (this will make it easier to whisk in Step 5).



2. Make pumpkin custard

In a large bowl (big enough for the bread), whisk **vanilla**, **pumpkin pie spice**, **brown sugar**, **1 cup milk** (not reserved ¼ cup), **3 eggs**, **⅓ cup pumpkin purée**, and **½ teaspoon salt** until fully combined (see recipe tip).



3. Soak bread

Add **bread cubes** to bowl with pumpkin custard and stir until bread is completely coated and submerged in custard.



4. Bake French toast

Reshape **aluminum tin**, if bent, then grease insides with **butter** and place on a baking sheet (for easy transfer to the oven). Pour **custard and bread** into prepared tin. Transfer baking sheet with **tin** to oven and bake until top is golden and custard is no longer runny, 25–30 minutes.



5. Toast pecans and make glaze

While French toast bakes, place **pecans** in a medium pan over medium-high heat. Toast, stirring, until golden and fragrant, 2–4 minutes (see recipe tip). Remove pan from heat, transfer **pecans** to a small bowl, and set aside. To bowl with cream cheese and milk, add **powdered sugar** and whisk to combine.



6. Plate pumpkin French toast

Once baked, set **French toast** aside to cool in tin for 10 minutes (this is a great time to pour a cup of coffee). Cut **pumpkin French toast bake** into 4 equal squares and divide between serving plates. Drizzle over **cream cheese glaze** and garnish with **toasted pecans**. Enjoy!

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